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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026 | Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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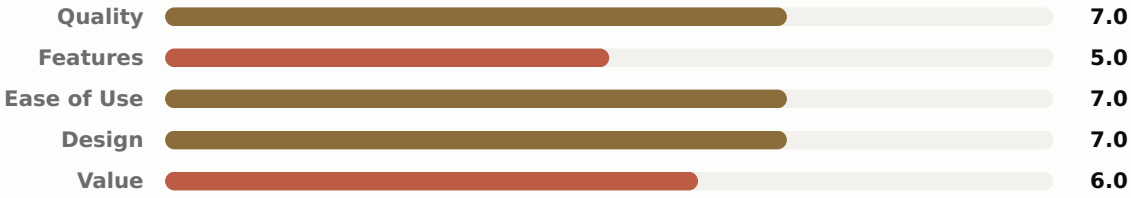
In a busy household, keeping floors spotless can feel like a full-time job. Robot vacuums promise hands-free cleaning, but not every model delivers the same convenience and performance. This straight-forward guide compares the premium Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, its base counterpart, and the feature-packed Shark AI Ultra so you can decide which robot vacuum best fits your budget, lifestyle, and cleaning needs.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Key Differences at a Glance

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo + Dock	Roomba 115X Combo (Base)	Shark AI Ultra
Price (2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99
Auto-Empty Dock	Yes – dustbin empties automatically	No – manual bin emptying	Not included – manual dustbin management
Suction Power	High – Gen 3 suction	High – Gen 3 suction	Very High – advanced brushless motor
Mopping Capability	Integrated dual-mode vacuum-mop	Integrated dual-mode vacuum-mop	Basic wet-dry mop with limited depth control

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You want a truly hands-free floor cleaner, but the premium price feels steep and the thought of climbing stairs to empty the bin interrupts your routine.

Trust: Owners give it a 4.4/5 rating from over 5,200 reviews, praising its reliable cycle and noting a 70% reduction in manual intervention compared with non-dock models.

Solution: The AutoEmpty Dock provides 24-hour autonomous dustbin emptying—just tap a button and the robot handles the rest. It shares the same Gen 3 suction and dual-mode vacuum-mop system as the base model, while the dock stores and empties dust and water for you.

Proof: Generation 3 navigation ensures precise mapping over complex floor plans, cutting downtime and catching pet hair trails. Maintenance requires only an occasional AutoEmpty pad replacement (≈ every 18 months).

Action: Check current price on Amazon and enjoy a virtually maintenance-free cleaning experience.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (Base Model)

Problem: Your budget limits you to around $140, yet you still need strong suction and mopping capability without sacrificing performance.

Trust: The base model shares the same 4.4/5 owner rating as its docked sibling, confirming consistent cleaning quality across the line.

Solution: For $139.99 you get the high-performance Gen 3 suction and integrated dual-mode vacuum-mop system—just without the auto-empty dock. Emptying the bin is a quick manual step after each cleaning cycle.

Proof: Users report effective pickup on carpets and hard floors, and the mop leaves a light-damp finish suitable for daily maintenance.

Action: See the base model on Amazon and start saving while keeping your floors clean.

Shark AI Ultra

Problem: You’re attracted to powerful suction and advanced navigation, but you worry about limited mopping control and the absence of an auto-empty feature.

Trust: Shark’s AI Ultra earns a solid 4.2/5 rating from thousands of buyers, with many highlighting its strong brushless motor and smart room-mapping.

Solution: At $249.99 it delivers very high suction via an advanced brushless motor and includes a basic wet-dry mop function. While it lacks an auto-empty dock, the large dustbin reduces emptying frequency.

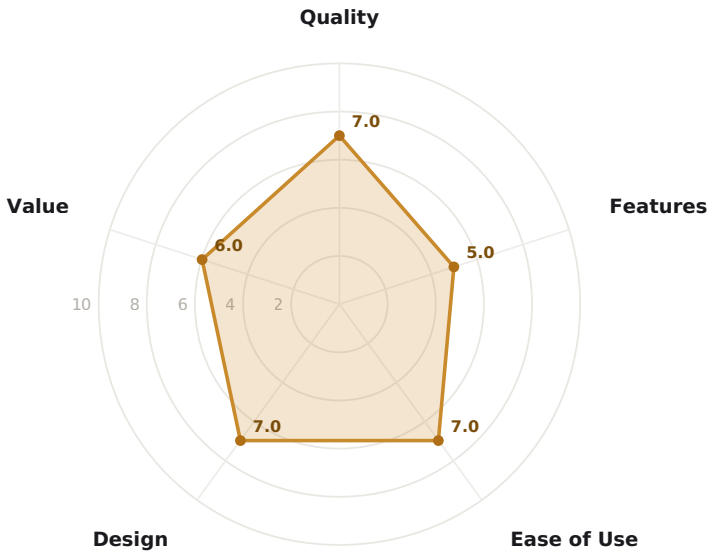
Proof: AI-driven navigation adapts to floor-plan changes, and the robot resumes cleaning after recharging—ideal for larger homes.

Action: View the Shark AI Ultra on Amazon and decide if the extra suction justifies the higher price.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.